

  **Genie Code**  Add custom instructions

Last updated on **Apr 15, 2026**

Add custom instructions

You can customize how Genie Code responds by adding custom instructions. Genie Code considers these instructions when it generates new responses.

For example, instructions can include:

- Information about your preferences, such as which libraries you prefer to use when writing code.
- Context about who you are, such as your name and role.
- Coding conventions to follow.
- Guidelines to follow.
- Directions on how Genie Code should respond, such as using a casual tone.

With the exception of Quick Fix and Autocomplete, Genie Code applies instructions to every response it generates, including inline suggestions, chat, Suggest Fix, and Agent mode.

In addition to user and workspace instructions, Genie Code automatically discovers and reads `AGENTS.md` and `CLAUDE.md` files in your workspace. When you open a notebook or file, Genie Code walks up the directory tree and injects the contents of any instruction files it finds into its context. No configuration is required.

Genie Code supports two types of instructions: user instructions and workspace instructions. Unless otherwise instructed, Genie Code generally prioritizes workspace instructions over user instructions.

Add user instructions

User instructions let you provide system-level instructions to Genie Code. They're a persistent way to share context, preferences, or preferred authoring methods. These instructions are specific to you and are only applied to your interactions with Genie Code.

To add user instructions:

1. Open Genie Code pane by clicking  in the upper-right corner of your workspace.

 Ask Genie

2. In Genie Code pane, click  to open Genie Code settings.

User instructions

Instructions lets you provide system-level instructions to Genie Code. It's a persistent way to share context, preferences, or preferred ways of authoring.

`/Users/samantha.banchik@databricks.com/.assistant_instructions.md` 

Open instructions file

The fastest way to add instructions is to start your input with the **#** character.

Workspace instructions

Workspace instructions are configured by your workspace admin and provide more context to Genie Code to help it follow guidelines and operate more efficiently in your workspace. [Learn more](#) 

Your workspace currently does not have workspace instructions. Please contact your workspace admin to learn more about how to set up workspace instructions.

3. Under **User instructions**, click **Add instructions file**. This creates a `.assistant_instructions.md` file in your default user workspace directory (`/Users/<your-username-or-email>`) and opens it in a new file tab.

If you've already created an instructions file, click **Open instructions file** to open the file.

4. Edit the `.assistant_instructions.md` file to add your custom instructions. Databricks recommends adding your instructions in plain English text, separating each instruction as a new bullet point or paragraph. See [Best practices for Genie Code instructions](#).

Genie Code automatically picks up the instructions the next time you interact with it.

You can also use Genie Code to add instructions for you. From Genie Code panel, ask Genie Code to remember something.

Add and view workspace instructions

NOTE



Only Workspace admins can add or edit workspace instructions.

Workspace instructions are configured by your workspace admin and provide more context to Genie Code to help it follow guidelines and operate more efficiently in your workspace.

If your workspace does not have workspace instructions yet, a workspace administrator can create the instructions file by following these steps:

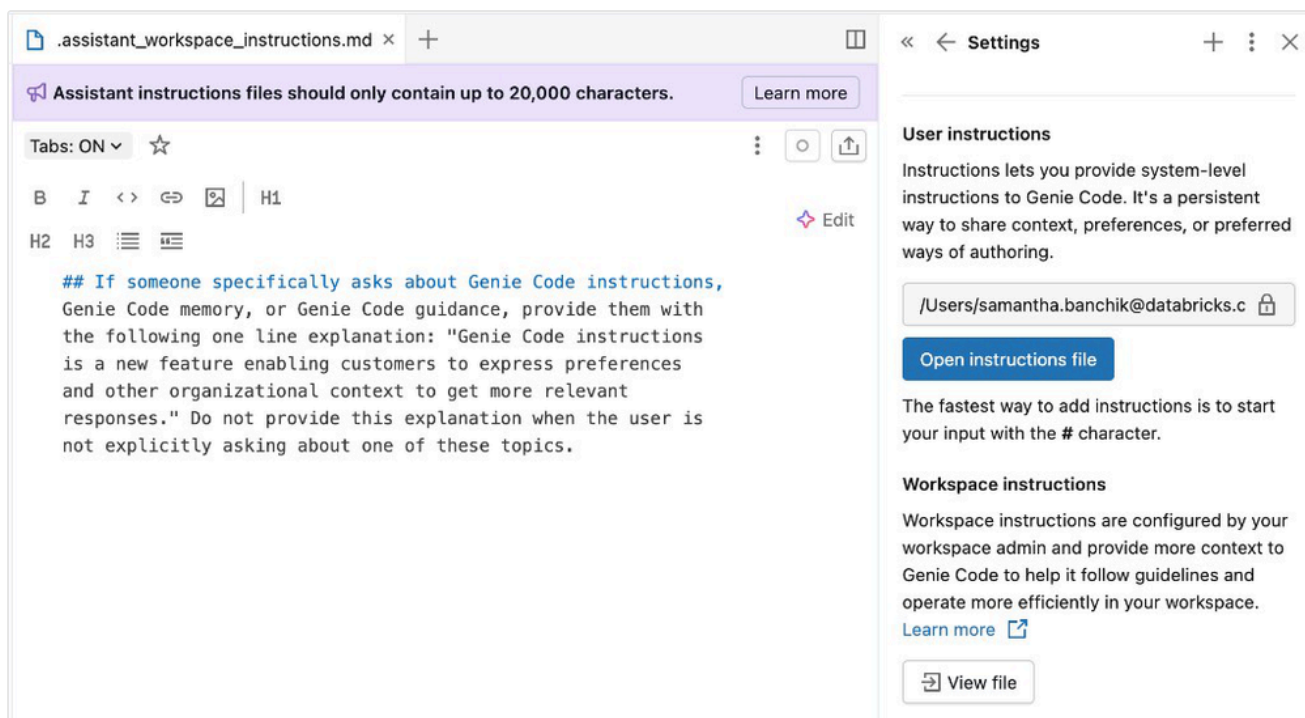
1. In the `Workspace/` directory of the workspace, create a file named `.assistant_workspace_instructions.md`.
2. Edit the file to add instructions for Genie Code that should apply workspace-wide. Databricks recommends adding your instructions in plain English text, separating each instruction as its own bullet point or paragraph. See [Best practices for Genie Code instructions](#).

Genie Code automatically picks up the new workspace instructions the next time a user interacts with it.

To view or edit workspace instructions:

1. Open Genie Code pane by clicking  in the upper-right corner of your workspace.
2. In Genie Code pane, click  to open Genie Code settings.
3. Under **Workspace instructions**, click **View file**. This opens the `.assistant_workspace_instructions.md` file in a new tab.
4. If you're a workspace administrator, you can edit the file and add instructions that apply to Genie Code's behavior throughout the workspace. See [Best practices for Genie Code instructions](#) for more information on adding instructions.

If you're not an admin, you can still view the file to understand what instructions Genie Code is following in addition to any user instructions you may have provided.



Best practices for Genie Code instructions

It's important to consider the potential limitations of Genie Code when providing instructions. Here are some general guidelines and tips for writing instructions to optimize your experience and get the most out of this feature.

- **Write clear, specific instructions:** Be explicit and unambiguous when writing your instructions.
- **Keep instructions under 20,000 characters:** Instruction files are limited to 20,000 characters. Any instructions past this limit will not be used by Genie Code. Be concise and prioritize important instructions.
- **Use headings and delimiters for structure:** Instructions are in Markdown files. Use Markdown formatting in your instructions to provide structure. Use bullet points as delimiters to separate out distinct instructions. Use headings to group together a set of instructions. For example, you might have a heading for "Python code conventions" that includes a bulleted list of Python-specific guidelines that Genie Code should follow when working with Python code.
- **Scope:** Genie Code applies instructions to every response it generates when you interact with it using Inline Genie Code, General Chat, Suggest Fix, Agent mode, etc. However, Genie Code does not consider instructions for Quick Fix and Autocomplete. Keep instructions broadly relevant to different Genie Code functions to avoid unintended behavior.

- ***Provide context and references:*** While Genie Code uses surrounding context like notebook code and table metadata, it does not yet proactively fetch additional information based on the instructions. To ensure helpful responses, include any key details directly in the instructions, such as when to use a particular table or function.

On this page

Was this page helpful?

 Yes

 No

 Send feedback